

The King of Tantras Called 'The All-Secret'

Sarva-rahasya-nāma-tantra-rāja · Toh 481 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 481 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in English as "The King of Tantras Called 'The All-Secret,'" in Sanskrit as the Sarva-rahasya-nāma-tantra-rāja, and in Tibetan as Thamché Sangwa Zhejawa Gyüdki Gyalpo. It belongs to the class of Buddhist tantras and is addressed to the Wisdom Bodhisattva, opening with verses on the nature of mind, the five elements as expressions of essential reality, and the non-dual wisdom of the buddhas as the supreme secret underlying all phenomena. The text presents itself as a "king of tantras," suggesting a text of particular authority within the tantric corpus, and its themes of self-knowing awareness, the unborn nature of mind, and the path to buddhahood through meditative cultivation place it within the broader tradition of highest yoga tantra literature preserved in the Kangyur.

In the language of India: Sarva-rahasya-nāma-tantra-rāja. In the language of Tibet: The King of Tantras Called "The All-Secret."

Homage to the Blessed One, the Wisdom Bodhisattva.

The five elements are themselves the essence of the five.

What is clearly seen in human bodies —

if one thoroughly cultivates one's own mind,

by meditating on that very thing, one will assuredly become a buddha.

The supreme secret of self-knowing

is the unsurpassed wisdom of the buddhas.

It has the character of non-duality within duality,

and I bow always before the buddhas.

Whatever arises from selflessness,

whatever arises from non-dual wisdom —

free of pleasant and unpleasant alike —

to that I make no bow at all.

Genuinely giving birth to the unborn,

then, in the wake of that birth, always

meditating on the buddha body —

I bow before one's own supreme wisdom.

For yogins and all sentient beings alike,
genuinely giving birth to the unborn,
then, in the wake of that birth, always —
afflictions and their habitual tendencies wear them down.
Those with bodies become entangled
in discrimination between the pleasant and the unpleasant.
That very mind is itself suffering,
and it is from that mind that the bodies of sentient beings arise.
It is through the continuum of that very mind
that the suffering of beings is pressed ever down.

Vairocana, the Victor who protects,
the sole gathering of all buddhas,
who has realized all buddhas,
and liberates buddhas from saṃsāra —
for the benefit of all sentient beings, each and every one,
he is genuinely endowed with the quality of compassion.
Through union with the suchness of the cause,
he also reveals the suchnesses of the fruit.
Entering into the suchness of the fruit,
he does not desire the suchness of the cause.
Wherever desire arises,
that is the habitual tendency of saṃsāra.

Through the rites of the wise,
meditation is thoroughly examined.
Whatever has once again become one,
the yoga of the yogin has arisen.
Recollecting and taking the buddhas as focus,
and taking the Dharma as focus in recollection,
through the joining of the two accumulations,
one becomes the supreme two-footed being.

Placing the liṅga at the secret center (bhaga),
meditate fully on the buddha body.
O yogin of buddha-recollection,
meditate on the cloud of buddhas.

Placing the liṅga at the secret center,
meditate fully on the vajra Dharma.

O yogin of Dharma-recollection,
let the rain pour down from the cloud of Dharma.

The līṅga is explained as the characteristic sign,
the four characteristics of the mudrā.

The bhaga is explained as "the destroyer" —
it is the supreme destroyer of afflictions.

For all sentient beings and all their things,
it is the Dharma of one's own mind gathered together.

When one is slain through the practice of the selflessness of phenomena,
one will oneself die.

One's own mind itself is the fully awakened buddha.

That which is to be realized is mind itself.

One's own mind itself is what is to be slain,
and it is mind itself alone that must be slain.

Joined and truly connected with the practice,
there is no arising of existence whatsoever.

At the time of one's buddha-awakening,
meditate on the five practices as "I am the buddha."

Arising from meditative absorption and wisdom —
since it is very buddhahood, in brief —
without buddha yoga,
a yogin will not awaken.

Just as one sees subtle things clearly,
so too with objects of beauty.

The distinction between substantial things and non-substantial things
is what meditation, in every instance, examines.

Meditating on a thing is not the thing itself.

What is to be meditated upon is not the meditation.

Through having meditated on things,
one's own mind is thoroughly purified.

The buddha is not the domain of a buddha.

Nor does it become the domain of sentient beings.

Rather, by realizing one's own mind, one is a buddha —
not by a buddha realizing a buddha.

In this non-dual practice as well,
wisdom is examined through meditative absorption.
Just as the suchness of the cause is seen,
so is the suchness of the fruit.

The suchness of the cause is not at all present.

The suchness of the fruit is just so.

That suchness — suchness itself — is known.

That suchness is the conduct of all yogins.

The cause does not make the cause into a thing.

The fruit does not make the fruit into a thing.

Yet that cause is fit to become the thing that is the fruit.

One's own mind appears distinctly and individually.

That gnosis is the very substance of the cause.

The secret — that is the substance of the fruit.

Through the non-dual practice of the secret,
by means of that very substance, it is supreme.

Having realized suchness upon suchness,
that secret is the yogin of the secret practice.

To know and understand that secret —
the supreme is the yogin of the supreme.

What is described as having the essential nature of the beautiful,
the ugly too is its very substance.

Whatever form is beautiful or ugly,
not seeing it — that is the Tathāgata.

Without mere consciousness being annihilated,
yoga does not arise from yoga.

Just as gnosis is supremely pure,
so too, in just that way, purity is the Tathāgata.

The four aspects of consciousness,
through the ritual of the four mudrās,
and by means of the non-dual engagement of the secret,
body, speech, and mind arose as they truly are.

The mind is the great mudrā (mahāmudrā).

The samaya mudrā pervades all.

The Dharma mudrā is that of speech.

The action mudrā belongs to the body.

The substance sealed by the seal —
the lord of secrets is the yogin of the secret practice.
Through the essential nature of self-knowing awareness,
meditative absorption and gnosis are examined.
The activity analyzed as body, speech, and mind,
and the action analyzed as tantra —
the secret is explained as three aspects,
in the manner of the diverse vajra-actions.

The identity of the five buddhas
is the supreme secret gnosis.
Through those four mudrās of the secret,
the yogin accomplishes the activities.
The four great elements
are likewise called the four mudrās.
The union practice of the four mudrās
is joined perfectly with the four goddesses.

Earth is called Locanā.
Water is called Māmakī.
What are known as fire and wind —
those are Pāṇḍaravāsīnī and Tārā.
The great lord is the element of earth.
The element of water is the water maṇḍala.
Fire is the element of fire.
Wind is the maṇḍala of wind.

The great lord's color is yellow,
and is square in shape, expanded.
The water maṇḍala is round,
white in color, and belongs to pacification.
The fire maṇḍala is red in color,
triangular, and belongs to activities of subjugation.
The wind maṇḍala is bow-shaped,
and belongs to fierce, wrathful activities.

Accomplished through the great elements themselves,
the four qualities of karmic attainment,
and the supreme karmic attainment — the highest attainment —
and the four kinds of wheel-turning sovereigns:

For pacification, there is the aspect of Locanā.
For enrichment, one bearing the lotus-vajra.
For subjugation, Vairocana is present.
For wrathful action, there is the fierce vajra.

Pacification is to be performed in the evening watch.
Likewise, enrichment in the morning.
Fierce activities at midday.
Activities of subjugation are to be performed at midnight.

For pacification, white is to be applied.
For enrichment, the appearance is yellow.
For activities of subjugation, red.
For the fierce, black is thoroughly applied.

That which arises from meditative absorption and gnosis —
the accomplishment of action is supreme.
The pure Blessed Ones are to be meditated upon.
One becomes unmoved from all the buddhas.

In the midst of the bhaga, the lord of secrets —
the vajra-space is the Tathāgata.
The identity that has become the lord of the five —
when meditated upon, one becomes without movement.

The great goddess dwelling in the heart
generates the yoga of the yogin.
The mother who generates all buddhas
is described as the sovereign of vajra-space.

Attachment, aversion, and delusion —
these are the three poisons of the world.
The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are without poison.
Vajra-space is the Tathāgata.

By meditating upon attachment, aversion, and bewilderment,
one becomes the lord of the three realms —
a buddha, a Blessed One —
and through the truth of the buddhas, the poisons are overcome.

By individually realizing one's own mind,
the mind of delusion is the Tathāgata.

Delusion itself becomes the world —
one must look upon all sentient beings.
The mind of aversion is the Tathāgata,
and generates the wisdom of subtlety perfectly.
Aversion, transformed, becomes vajra itself;
all sentient beings are to be liberated.

The mind of attachment is the Tathāgata,
and generates the awakening mind perfectly.
Attachment, transformed, becomes goodness itself;
all buddhas are to be embraced with love.

The mind of loving-kindness is the Tathāgata.
Having perfectly generated pride,
one becomes beloved and becomes all —
embrace all buddhas.

Through the view of attachment, loving-kindness;
speaking the Dharma of compassion;
granting fearlessness to all;
and pleasing all buddhas —

from generosity in yoga, supreme joy arises;
from moral discipline, one becomes stainless;
from patience, one becomes a source of light;
from diligence, one comes to possess radiance;
from meditative concentration, what is hard to purify is refined;
through wisdom, one sees the manifest;
through great skillful means, one goes far;
from possessing power, one becomes immovable;
through aspirational prayer, one comes to possess excellent intelligence;
from possessing primordial wisdom, a cloud of Dharma.

The Victor, the Tathāgata,
becomes eleven through self-knowing selfhood:
the ten perfections (pāramitās),
powers and mastery perfected,
having gone beyond the ten grounds (bhūmis),
and marks that have become stable — from that,
vajra-water is the fully awakened buddha.

Extracting the nectar of Dharma —
the boundless expanse of all buddhas —
is abandoning apprehended and apprehender.
Extract it with the essence of Dharma's nectar.
By purely drinking the vajra-water,
the vajra master, the yogin,
becomes primordially pure at that very moment.
Having come to abide as primordially pure,
one then becomes the awakening mind,
comes to possess the awakening mind as one's own,
and becomes a bodhisattva Tathāgata,
clothed in the garment of complete liberation.
The awakening mind is unsurpassed.

The yogin who has perfectly generated it —
Vajrasattva dwells in the heart.
Holding the commitment of the limitless realm of sentient beings,
if one practices with the vajra commitment,
one will always abide in the commitment.

All that is called "woman" along the path of the three realms,
delightful and experiential —
engage with all of them in accordance with the ritual,
and do not disparage the vajra of mind.
Abide in the bodies of the three vajras.
All commitments and mudrās that exist —
perform them with the three vajra commitments.
Do not disparage the vajra of speech.

All the mudrās arising from Vajrasattva
are good women.
The yogin who relies upon them
comes to master all mudrās.

Throughout all world-realms,
however many are called "woman" —
they are the practice of the Great Seal (mahāmudrā).
Engage closely with all of them.

The yogin of the supreme secret
possesses sacred samādhi and primordial wisdom.

If one desires the supreme spiritual attainment (siddhi),
no pride, no hūṃ,
no vidyā, no mantra-knowledge,
and one does not place hand mudrās.

Do not perform the activities of a stūpa.

Do not read books either.

Do not perform maṇḍalas.

Do not seek the salutation of the three supreme vajras.

Do not disparage the master —
the guru is equal to all buddhas.

You are to slay living beings.

You are to speak words of falsehood.

You are to take what is not given.

You are to rely upon another's woman.

Not fire offering, nor meditative concentration —
not dividing body, speech, and mind,
but acting with a mind unlike any other:
this is the supreme secret.

All mantras are fully accomplished,
and all yoga in every aspect —
therefore, with all effort,
one must meditate upon the Dharma of the buddhas.

The eighteen unmixed qualities
are described as the Dharma of the buddhas.

Always meditating upon them —

the Dharma of the buddhas is the means of accomplishment.

The four meditative concentrations and the four formless absorptions,
attained without interruption,
together with the absorption of cessation —
by these one fully accomplishes the awakening of a buddha.

The thirty-seven factors of awakening (bodhipakṣa),
whatever has been rightly taught as Dharma —
by meditating upon them one is purified,
and the bodhisattva benefits all beings.

The mind that delights in beings,
firm and ardently cultivating the essence,

arising from the suchness of emptiness —
this is called vajra wisdom.

Arising rightly from the selflessness of phenomena,
it is the supreme non-dual wisdom.

The wisdom that is the highest nature of reality
is rightly called the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena.

This is the wisdom of the dharmadhātu,
born from vajra-like meditative absorption.

The mind whose nature is vajra wisdom —
that is declared to be the vajra realm.

Through the union born of the mind's delight,
the union of the subtler wisdom and so forth is engaged.
The wisdom of all the Tathāgatas
is declared to be Vairocana.

Through the union born of loving-kindness' delight,
the supreme one who engages in the practice of union —
the mind that has grown firm, without defilement —
is declared to be Akṣobhya (the Imperturbable).

Through the manner of compassion's delight,
the one who bestows benefit upon sentient beings,
whose mind is truly endowed with the welfare of beings —
is declared to be Ratnasambhava (the Jewel-Born).

Through the union born of joy's delight,
the supreme Great Vehicle, stainless —
the mind that is luminosity, pure —
is declared to be Amitābha.

By the force of equanimity's delight,
the one who causes all sentient beings to awaken,
supremely meaningful and unsurpassed —
is declared to be Amoghasiddhi (the One of Accomplished Meaning).

The supreme wisdom that is the nature of awakening —
this is here declared to be vajra.

Arising from vajra wisdom —
that is declared to be Vajrasattva.

The one who summons all buddhas —
is declared to be Vajrāṅkuśa (the Vajra Hook).
The sovereign of all members of the vajra family —
is declared to be Vajrarāja (the Vajra King).

That by which all buddhas are made to be attracted,
the one who gives pleasure —
the great attachment of Māra's union —
is declared to be Vajrarāga (Vajra Passion).

That which pleases all the buddhas,
beginning with the exclamation "Excellent!" and so forth,
the one who brings joy to the bodhisattvas —
is declared to be Vajrasādhū (Vajra Excellence).

Whatever generosity of the bodhisattva
arises from the vajra equal to space —
the great meaningful jewel —
is declared to be Vajraratna (the Vajra Jewel).

The wisdom free of ignorance,
arising definitely from pure accumulations,
the great splendor that is the illumination of liberation —
is declared to be Vajrasūrya (the Vajra Sun).

The wisdom that is real in all aspects,
which grants entry and attainment on the path of liberation,
the great victory-banner crest of Dharma —
is declared to be Vajraketu (the Vajra Banner).

Vajrahāsa (Vajra Laughter), the great yoga —
the wondrous one from whom all buddhas arise —
this is the great bodhisattva
declared to be Vajrahāsa.

The great yoga of all the buddhas,
the one who realizes the Dharma of the buddhas,
the pure Dharma of the Tathāgatas —
is declared to be Vajradharma (Vajra Dharma).

The Great Vehicle with its sharp wisdom,
the one who decisively cuts through all afflictions,
the one who severs the cognitive obscurations —

is declared to be Vajratīkṣṇa (the Sharp Vajra).

The musical wheel of the buddhas,
vigorously turning the wheel of Dharma —
the great being of the Great Vehicle —
is declared to be Vajrahetu (the Vajra Cause).

Whose nature is wisdom and gnosis, utterly pure,
who has relinquished all sounds of voice,
who has become the embodiment of gentle speech —
is declared to be Vajrabhāṣa (the Vajra Speaker).

The foot of all perfections,
the one who realizes all phenomena,
the emanator for the benefit of all sentient beings —
is declared to be Vajrakarma (Vajra Action).

The one in whom recollection of the buddhas is perfectly established,
who has fully abandoned the Lesser Vehicle,
who has entered fully into the awakening mind —
is declared to be Vajrarakṣa (the Vajra Protector).

The one who exhausts all evil,
who likewise burns away all afflictions,
who appropriates the exhaustion of afflictions —
is declared to be Vajrayakṣa (the Vajra Yakṣa).

The vajras of body, speech, and mind,
having become perfectly unified as a single binding,
and that very suchness, that very suchness as gnosis —
is declared to be Vajramuṣṭi (the Vajra Fist).

All pledges (samaya) and mudrās
arise perfectly from the vajra-fist binding.
The two vajra fists joined together —
is declared to be the karma mudrā (action seal).

Without pride and without appearance,
without marks and without clinging,
the gnosis of selflessness and equality —
is declared to be Vajrasattva (the Vajra Being).

In this union of the secret,
the virtue of the Perfection of Wisdom
arose perfectly in twelve aspects —
the light of the vajra perfections.

Through the thorough cultivation of the awakening mind,
the gnosis that attains the perfection reaching the other shore of buddhahood
—
is declared to be Vajracitta (the Vajra Mind).

The four bases of gathering sentient beings,
the vajra of the Perfection of Wisdom,
and the four dharmas unified as one —
is declared to be Vajraratna (the Vajra Jewel).

The secret gnosis, the great gnosis,
that very virtue of the perfection,
arising from the great perfection —
is to be known as Vajradharma (the Vajra Dharma).

The virtue of the perfections,
excellently taught as the means of engagement —
is to be known as Vajrakarma (Vajra Action),
for it is the pleasant sport of its nature.

The coquette is the perfection of generosity.
The virtue of the perfection of moral discipline
is the pleasing limb that adorns.

The songstress is the perfection of patience,
the one who proclaims the Dharma through set speech.

The dancer is the perfection of diligence,
the one who swiftly bestows buddhahood.

The incense is the perfection of wisdom,
since it spreads to pervade everything.

The flower is the perfection of meditative concentration,
unstained by the mire of desire.

The lamp is the perfection of aspiration,
illuminating all directions.

The fragrance is the perfection of skillful means,
the virtue that dispels foul odors.

The great skillful means of all buddhas
abides in four distinct divisions.

The great skillful means fulfilling all wishes —
is declared to be Vajrāṅkuśa (the Vajra Hook).

The one who brings about the conduct of awakening —
is declared to be Vajrapāśa (the Vajra Lasso).

Whatever brings stability to this vehicle —
is declared to be Vajrasphota (the Vajra Chain).

Since all phenomena are unborn
and primordially at peace, equal to space,
the one who perfectly enters into such speech —
is declared to be Vajraghaṇṭā (the Vajra Bell).

Through the engagement of the two accumulations,
the mind that reveals the benefit of all sentient beings,
luminous by its very nature —
is declared to be the lunar maṇḍala.

The realization of the true vajra
is itself the hook, being the engagement of grasping.

The one that pierces subtly is called the arrow.

Delight is called Excellent!

What is adorned is declared to be the jewel.

Splendor is called the sun.

What is raised up is declared to be the pinnacle.

What differentiates is declared to be laughter.

The purification of attachment is the lotus.

The vanquishing of afflictions is the sword.

The engagement of the maṇḍala is the wheel.

Whatever proclaims through its declaration is declared to speak.

The totality of variety is the vajra.

The engagement that is hard to destroy is the armor.

The fearsome conduct is the fang.

The engagement of the mudrā is the binding.

What is taught within the maṇḍala —
the mind itself is the supreme maṇḍala.

The palace is gnosis,
the raising up is the stacking of the mind.

Whatever forms the outer square,

having become equal through measure —
whatever mind there is of loving-kindness and so forth
is declared to be the four lines.

The recollection of Dharma engagement:
that is declared to be the vajra line.

What is perfectly freed from all views
is declared to be the gnosis line.

The excellence of the assembly of moral discipline
is declared to be the ornament.

Whatever mind there is of the faculty of faith and so forth
arises perfectly as the five enclosures.

The four liberations
are perfectly taught as the gateways.

The four right abandonments
arise as the pillars.

The four foundations of mindfulness
are to be known as the four cloisters.

The four bases of miraculous power
are the four threshold lintels.

The seven limbs of awakening —
adorned with garlands of flower clusters —
the eight limbs of the noble path
are taught to be the eight pillars.

Freed from the two obscurations
and examined by meditative absorption and gnosis,
the distinctive excellences of the wisdom of the path
are perfectly taught as the fan.

Cutting through all afflictions,
by the seizure of afflictions — the net:
the very act of perfectly cutting and abandoning,
abiding in the abandonment that clears away,
is the union of the two accumulations.

The half-seizure of afflictions
is taught to be the half-net.

That which is luminosity by intrinsic nature
is the unsurpassed awakening mind (bodhicitta).
Mind, which produces every meaning and aim,
is taught to be the lunar maṇḍala.

The purified intrinsic nature of wisdom and gnosis,
arisen as vajra-like meditative absorption —
the brilliant radiance of the light of liberation —
is taught to be the solar maṇḍala.

Perfectly taught as the five pigments,
they are the flowers of the five views.
Their union with the five wisdoms
is perfectly taught as the five buddhas.

The consciousness that is selfless as space
is the supreme gnosis.
The ornament of that gnosis, as it is taught,
is said to be the mind of attachment.

From detachment arises awakening;
it is other than the mind of attachment.
Therefore, both attachment and detachment
are perfectly taught as the awakening mind (bodhicitta).

The world is tamed through detachment,
yet the attainments of the mudrā arise from attachment.
The meditations on skillful means therein
bestow all attainments.

However the world is to be tamed,
in just that way the yogin should practice.
However the beings to be tamed have become,
every kind of clinging shall be worshipped.

Whatever is perfectly taught as the defining characteristic
will be indicated by that characteristic.
The gnosis sealed with the mudrā of body, speech, and mind
is taught to be gnosis sealed by those.

By meditating on the mudrā, the yogin
perpetually becomes a possessor of the mudrā.
Understanding the entity that has been sealed,

if one meditates, one becomes sealed by the mudrā.

Knowing the connection between the marks and the defining characteristics,
the yogin engages in authentic practice.

Just as the defining characteristic is perfectly established,
so too purity is swiftly accomplished.

By the marks of the right side,
the one endowed with wisdom is perfectly indicated.
By the marks of the left side, as they are seen,
compassion is indicated thereby.

From the union of both hands together,
the two meditative absorptions are taught.
By the marks of the two feet,
the two accumulations are taught.

From the union of the five fingers,
it is adorned by the five maṇḍalas.
The manifest awakening of the five buddhas
is to be taught in sequential order.

Whoever displays the middle finger
indicates what has arisen from space.
Whoever displays the index finger —
that is the maṇḍala of the great lord.
Whoever displays the ring finger
is said to be the water maṇḍala.
Whoever displays the thumb —
that indicates fire.
Whoever displays the little finger —
that becomes the wind maṇḍala.

Whoever displays the navel
is taught to be the lord of the vajra-space.
Whoever displays the heart
is to be understood as Vajrasattva.
Whoever displays the brow-centre
is called Vajraratna.
Whoever displays the throat
is to be known as Vajradharma.

Whoever displays the crown of the head
is to be known as Vajrakarma.

Whether awakened to manifest awakening in the five awakenings,
or endowed with the five wisdoms,
or perfectly possessing the five buddhas —
the maṇḍala of awakening is thereby taught.

What was taught as the sound in front
is perfectly indicated there as the first.
What was taught as the sound behind
is perfectly indicated thereafter as the latter.

Whatever arises as the first sound
is taught there as the sound of cause.
Whatever arises as the last sound
is here perfectly taught as result.

There are not two blessed buddhas.
There is no having both cause and result.
Because there is no first and no last,
therefore it is taught as permanent.

By realizing one's own mind, one becomes a buddha,
and that which is to be realized is mind itself.
What is spoken of as "a buddha-field"
should be understood as bodhicitta.

Sentient beings whose nature is pure
are perfectly explained as universally aware.
The pure nature of sentient beings
should be understood as bodhicitta.

Whatever arose first, strike it to the heart.
One becomes stable in that very itself.
Grasping the hair at the crown of the head,
in Amitābha one rests in meditative equipoise.

When closed, what is thereafter taught
is the Tathāgata's vajra speech.
The union of the two faculties
is taught as Vairocana.

What the supreme man, the Sage, taught
when the maiden was twelve years of age
is taught as the twelve perfections;
it is not to be examined otherwise.

What the Tathāgata taught
when the maiden was sixteen years of age
is the sound of the meditation practice
of the bodhisattvas Vajrasattva and the rest.

What the wheel-turner spoke
when the goddess was twenty years of age
possesses the nature of twenty offerings
and corresponds in sequence to the twentieth.

One's own consort is taught to be
of one's own kind, arisen from self-awareness.
Whatever is presented as another's consort
is the awareness of another — the delight of another.

What is taught as urine and vajra
is unsurpassed vajra wisdom.
What is taught as excrement and lotus
is the Dharma wisdom that is free of turbidity.

That which knows with full illumination
is the sacred heart-maṇḍala.
One worships through the conduct
of body, speech, and mind with effort —
one's own vajra endowed with the lotus,
arising from the two faculties.
With one's own seminal fluid, the bindu,
one should worship Vajrasattva.

By the union of the two accumulations,
all buddhas are gathered into one.
Resting upon non-duality within duality,
one is fully endowed with the experience of compassion.

By the union of the two faculties,
through the seminal fluid, the skilled one,
when the great yoga has arisen,

consecrates the maṇḍala perfectly with blessing.

One who laughs or speaks expansively,
or performs the dance of buddha entertainment,
through the union of the four goddesses
delights in what moves and what does not move.

By what is secret and well enclosed,
and by what is proportionate and beautiful,
the wise one draws the lines —
through meditation on body, speech, and mind.

Four-cornered with four gates,
beautified by four archways,
perfectly endowed with four lines,
adorned with silk and garlands of flowers —

in every corner of the boundary walls
and within the interiors of the gate-frames,
ornamented with vajras and jewels,
draw the lines of the outer maṇḍala.

Entirely encircled by a vajra line
and beautifully adorned by eight pillars —
what abides within the eight pillars
is presented as the eightfold maṇḍala,
and the square maṇḍala at the boundary
is worshipped by the assembly of vajra goddesses.

Perfectly endowed with five wheels,
adorned in full by five maṇḍalas,
ornamented with netting and half-netting
and embellished with fans —

measure it at twelve cubits,
or examine it as sixteen cubits,
or again at just twenty cubits,
or endowed with twenty-five.

By twenty-five cubits
the maṇḍala is perfectly consecrated with blessing.

The middle portion of the gates,
divided into nine equal parts —
envisioning it as the gate of the maṇḍala,
the gate-frame is to be applied there.

The form of the gate-frame maṇḍala,
equal to the heart maṇḍala,
is divided into nine parts,
and the square maṇḍala at the boundary is set aside.

Finally, endowed with a surrounding walkway,
adorned by the five maṇḍalas,
perfectly possessing the five colors —
examine it as foursquare.

The five views are greatly difficult to traverse.
The Tathāgatas of the five colors —
united with the five buddhas,
the ground is thoroughly transformed by means of color.
In the center of the five maṇḍalas,
the five buddhas are to be placed.

Pervaded by the five colors and meditative absorption,
pervaded by the five sense-qualities of desire —
like the radiance of crystal and moonlight,
gathering all buddhas into one:
the Tathāgata Vairocana,
the Tathāgata of the heroic gaze.

Like the radiance of indranīla sapphire,
gathering all vajras into one,
arisen from the primordial wisdom of Akṣobhya —
the Tathāgata of the vajra gaze.

Like the radiance of Jambu-river gold,
gathering all buddhas into one,
arisen for the sake of all sentient beings —
the Tathāgata of the blazing gaze.

Great hero, like the lotus,
with the radiance of a padmarāga ruby jewel,
arisen from the primordial wisdom of the Dharma —

the Tathāgata of the impassioned gaze.

Like the radiance of emerald,
gathering all buddhas into one,
arisen from the single source of all buddhas —
the Tathāgata of the loving gaze.

The pure ground of the central region
is the color of jewel-crystal.
In the eastern direction it is deep blue,
in the south it is endowed with yellow,
in the western direction it is red,
and in the north it is perfectly endowed with green.

As for that which possesses the surrounding walkway —
at the gate, the walkway is absent.

What is rightly called the center
is the unsurpassed primordial wisdom of the buddhas.
All other aims are perfectly present:
it is the supreme meditative absorption and primordial wisdom.

Abiding at the center of the expanse of space,
envision the supreme lunar maṇḍala.
Meditating on the body of the buddha,
envision the eyes at the center.
The beautiful face, with wide eyes,
the color of jewel-crystal,
all marks perfectly complete —
the supreme holder of the woman of illusion.

Meditate on the wheel in the hand —
the one who commands the three realms,
the primordial wisdom that accomplishes all things,
the color of the wish-fulfilling wheel-jewel.

Absorbed into the center of the sky-vajra,
envision the supreme lunar maṇḍala.
Meditating on the body of the buddha,
meditate on the supreme sky-vajra.
The beautiful face, with wide eyes,

the color of blue utpala petals,
all marks perfectly complete —
envision the supreme illusion of space.

In the hand, a blue-red utpala —
the one who caused the three realms to bow down,
the supreme one who brings about the buddhas' awakening,
the vajra-holder of the secret attainment.

Absorbed into the center of the sky-vajra,
envision the supreme lunar maṇḍala.
Meditating on the body of the buddha,
envision the Vajradharma.

The beautiful face, with wide eyes,
the color of padmarāga ruby,
the body color arisen as perfect red,
lovely holder of the lotus of desire,
all marks perfectly complete,
adorned with every ornament.

In the hand a red utpala —
the one who has meditated on all buddhas,
the supreme one who produces the primordial wisdom of the Dharma,
the vajra-holder of the secret vow.

Absorbed into the center of the space-expanse vajra,
envision the supreme lunar maṇḍala.
Meditating on the form of the buddha,
envision the supreme Tārā.

The beautiful face, with wide eyes,
thoroughly adorned with varied ornaments,
envision the color as yellow,
the one who has abandoned the pride of the woman of illusion.

In the hand, the noble utpala —
meditate on it appearing as yellow.
Arisen from the vajra-self-grasping,
she before whom all sentient beings bow down.

Oṃ ru ru sphuru jvala tiṣṭha siddha locane sarva-artha sādhanī svāhā.
Oṃ śaṃkare śāntikare ghruṭṭha ghruṭṭhīni ghātaya ghātaya ghuṭṭhīni svāhā.
Oṃ kaṭe vikaṭe nikaṭe kaṭaṃ kaṭe svāhā.

Oṃ tāre tuttāre ture svāhā.

These are the four vidyā goddesses (Skt. vidyādevī).

The body is of the very nature of the physical form;
the mind is of the very nature of the mental form;
the speech is of the very nature of verbal form.
When offered to, one becomes the very self of the offering.

The secrets of body, speech, and mind —
these are to be guarded by the wise.

When guarded, the supreme secret
arises perpetually and everywhere.
When the complete purity of things
is absent, no thorough examination arises anywhere.

The yogin (Skt. yogin) attains yoga,
yet without the accumulation, the real is not seen.
Therefore the gnosis of the secret arises,
and yoga comes to arise everywhere and at all times.

The method of the Perfection of Wisdom
is to be examined through meditative absorption and gnosis.
All phenomena being completely pure —
that which has become purity itself —
is just as the divine wish-fulfilling jewel
ever shines by its own radiance.
And the complete purity of existence
is what enables the yogin to attain yoga.

To one who is skilled in conferring empowerment
in the vajra-expanse as the great secret,
the supreme yoga of the secret of mind —
that is what the wise one should expound to such a person.

Here ends the king of tantras entitled "The Secret of All."

Translator's Notes

- The text presents several genuinely difficult interpretive challenges. The section involving "bhaga" and "liṅga" uses these terms in a technical tantric register where "liṅga" means the symbolic marker or indicator and "bhaga" means the destroyer of afflictions, as the text itself

glosses them. However, these Sanskrit terms also carry their ordinary anatomical meanings, and the passage may intentionally exploit this ambiguity for tantric initiatory purposes. The translation renders the text's own explicit glosses faithfully.

The phrase rendered "meditating on the five practices as 'I am the buddha'" involves "sbyor lnga" which can mean "the five unions" or "the five practices" or "the five applications." The precise referent of these five is not specified in this passage and likely depends on a commentarial tradition not present here.

The line rendered "liberates buddhas from saṃsāra" is grammatically awkward in context and may mean "who is himself a buddha liberated from saṃsāra" — but the Tibetan reads "sangsgyas 'khor ba sgrol ba po" most naturally as "the one who liberates buddhas from saṃsāra," which, while unusual, may be a deliberate paradox.

- The phrase "bhaga" is left in Sanskrit as it is a Tantric technical term referring to the female generative principle or the consort's sacred dimension; it appears here in an explicitly Vajrayāna context where the Sanskrit is the appropriate rendering.

The line "the great lord" renders a term that in other contexts means the deity Mahādeva (Śiva), but here it functions as the name of the earth-element deity within the maṇḍala system of the four elements; no disambiguation as Śiva is warranted in this context since the text is describing tantric elemental correspondences rather than the Hindu deity.

The final couplet — "By individually realizing one's own mind, the mind of delusion is the Tathāgata" — is doctrinally striking and is rendered as the text states; it reflects the non-dual tantric view that afflictions, when recognized in their true nature, are themselves the buddha-nature.

- The passage contains a well-known Vajrayāna antinomian rhetorical device: the commands to slay, lie, steal, and take another's consort are deliberately transgressive formulations expressing the tantric principle that the three poisons and conventional prohibitions are to be transformed rather than conventionally observed. They are not literal ethical prescriptions but doctrinal provocations meant to indicate that the yogin of the supreme secret acts from non-dual awareness, not from karmic conditioning. The translation preserves the literal imperative form precisely because that provocative literalism is the point of the passage, and any softening would misrepresent the text.

The phrase rendered "eleven through self-knowing selfhood" reflects a tantric enumerative scheme in which the Tathāgata's qualities are counted as eleven categories comprising the ten perfections plus the further qualities listed; the precise referent of "eleven" is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan and may vary by commentarial tradition.

The final line ending "always meditating upon them —" is left open because the Tibetan passage ends mid-sentence, clearly continuing in the next passage.

- The passage enumerates a series of vajra-family deity names, each associated with a quality of wisdom, an aspect of the four immeasurables (loving-kindness, compassion, joy, equanimity) or a buddha of the five families. The identification of the four immeasurables with the five buddha families (Akṣobhya with loving-kindness, Ratnasambhava with compassion, Amitābha with joy, Amoghasiddhi with equanimity) follows a Vajrayāna doctrinal schema and has been rendered accordingly. The final verse is incomplete as the source passage breaks off mid-sentence.

- The passage contains a sustained allegorical identification of maṇḍala architectural features with Dharma categories, and of offering goddesses with the perfections. The rendering of རྩ་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཡུལ་ as "square" and རྩ་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཡུལ་ as "lines" follows the commentarial tradition interpreting these as architectural elements of the inner maṇḍala palace. The phrase

何んが笑ふを宣ふ, literally "what differentiates is declared to be laughter," may refer to the wrathful or joyful laughter of a tantric deity figure; the rendering is literal since the context is a list of symbolic identifications.

- The passage is a dense, allusive tantric text listing structural correspondences between components of a ritual maṇḍala, mudrā gestures, anatomical points, and doctrinal categories such as the five buddhas, five wisdoms, and two accumulations. The language is intentionally cryptic.

The phrase rendered "mind of attachment" translates a term that in this tantric context is a technical euphemism for the consort or the bliss-mind generated in union practice, not ordinary craving. The text plays on the paradox of attachment and detachment as twin aspects of bodhicitta in the tantric sense. This is a genuine doctrinal subtlety that the translation preserves literally; readers should be aware the term carries a specialized Vajrayāna meaning distinct from the kleśa of rāga.

The final four lines about "first and last sound" and "cause and result" being non-dual, with the conclusion "therefore it is taught as permanent," are likely referring to the nonduality of the mantra syllables or of the causal and fruitional vehicles, resolving into a timeless or primordially pure state described paradoxically as "permanent." This is a genuinely difficult passage and the translation follows the Tibetan closely without over-interpretation.

- The passage is from a tantric scripture, most likely the Guhyasamāja-related or Mahāyoga cycle, and employs the coded "intentional language" (twilight language, Skt. *sandhyābhāṣā*) characteristic of such texts. Several verses deliberately use transgressive or scatological imagery (urine, excrement, seminal fluid) as symbolic technical terms for specific wisdoms and ritual substances; these have been rendered plainly as the text presents them, since the commentary tradition identifies them explicitly with gnosis categories. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, and the translation reflects that open ending faithfully.

The phrase rendered "what moves and what does not move" (पञ्चभूतानि च पञ्चभूतानि) refers to animate and inanimate phenomena, a standard Indic cosmological binary.

- The four mantras at the close of the verse section are transliterated Sanskrit dhāraṇīs embedded in the Tibetan text and are rendered as-is in standard Sanskrit transliteration. The first is recognizable as a form of the Locana dhāraṇī; the last is the well-known Tārā mantra. The second and third are less standard and may reflect regional or textual variants; no emendation has been made.

The phrase rendered "the woman of illusion" (sgyu ma'i mchog 'dzin pa / sgyu ma'i dregs bor ba) is a tantric characterization of goddesses as illusory consorts; "holder of the supreme illusion-woman" and "one who has abandoned the pride of the illusion-woman" are the respective senses.

The epithet "sky-vajra" (nam mkha'i rdo rje) likely refers to a specific deity or samādhi-name within the mandala being described; it has been rendered consistently throughout.

- The phrase rendered "complete purity of existence" translates *srid pa yongs su dag pa*, where *srid pa* (Skt. *bhava*) refers to conditioned existence or *samsāric* being. The line conveys a tantric non-dual understanding that existence itself, fully purified in view, is the very ground of yogic attainment rather than something to be abandoned.

The final colophon "king of tantras entitled The Secret of All" (Thams cad gsang ba zhes bya ba'i rgyud kyi rgyal po) is a standard Tibetan tantra colophon formula marking the close of the text.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.